Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	03 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Employee Data Import using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) - ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

This template has been used by our team to explore how data from a spreadsheet can be imported into ServiceNow using **Transform Maps**, so that every record is linked to an employee and details such as department are available for easier reporting and secured with Access Control Lists (ACLs).

Reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Problem Statement: Linking each record to an employee and pulling some employee details (like department) into the record for easier reporting.

Objective: To implement an Access Control List (ACL) by using Impersonate User. This provides a solid foundation for managing and securing data in ServiceNow using key platform features.

Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

10 minutes to prepare
1 hour to collaborate
2-8 people recommended

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going. **10 minutes**

A. Team gathering
Team members who joined the session: all project members, with pre-work shared in advance (ServiceNow basics, sample spreadsheet).

B. Set the goal
Implement ACLs using Impersonate User on records linked to employees, with data loaded through Transform Maps.

C. Learn the facilitation tools
Use the facilitation tools to run a happy and productive session.

Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? **5 minutes**

PROBLEM

How might we link each record to an employee and pull employee details (like department) into the record, using spreadsheet data imported through Transform Maps, for easier reporting?

Key rules of brainstorming

Stay in topic. | Encourage wild ideas.
Defer judgment. | Listen to others.
Go for volume. | If possible, be visual.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2 Brainstorm - Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement. **10 minutes**

Person 1	Person 2	Person 3	Person 4
Create Data Source and attach the Excel file	Auto-pull Department with a field map script	Create ACL on Department field	Scheduled import for regular updates
Map Employee ID to reference field (sys_user)	Clean headers and blank rows before load	Test access with Impersonate User	onBefore script to skip invalid rows
Set Coalesce on Employee ID	Check Transform History for errors	Role-based access (HR vs Employee)	Report/dashboard grouped by Department

3 Group ideas - Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. Give each cluster a sentence-like label. **20 minutes**

Cluster A: Import setup	Cluster B: Employee linking
Create Data Source and attach file; clean headers and blank rows; check Transform History.	Map Employee ID to reference field; set Coalesce on Employee ID; auto-pull Department.

Cluster C: Security (ACL)	Cluster D: Automation & Reporting
Create ACL on Department field; role-based access; test using Impersonate User.	Scheduled import; onBefore script to skip invalid rows; Department-wise report.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4 Prioritize - Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.
20 minutes

No.	Idea	Importance	Feasibility
1	Create Data Source and load spreadsheet	High	High
2	Set Coalesce on Employee ID	High	High
3	Map Employee ID to reference field (sys_user)	High	High
4	Auto-pull Department using field map script	High	Medium
5	ACL on fields tested with Impersonate User	Very High	Medium
6	Clean and validate spreadsheet before import	Medium	High
7	Scheduled import for regular updates	Low	Medium
8	Department-wise report / dashboard	Medium	Low-Medium

Outcome: Ideas 1, 2, 3 and 5 are selected as top priority: import the spreadsheet through a Data Source, use Coalesce to avoid duplicates, link records to employees through a reference field, and secure the data with ACLs verified by Impersonate User.